



Angola

Located in southwest Africa, Angola suffered a civil war following independence from Portugal in 1975, until a 2002 peace deal. Hundreds of thousands of people died.



GEOGRAPHY

Most of the land is hilly and grass-covered. Desert in the south. Mountains in the center and north.



CLIMATE

Varies from temperate to tropical. Rainfall decreases north to south. Coast is cooler and dry.



PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Civil war pitched the ruling Kimbundu-dominated MPLA against UNITA, representing the Ovimbundu. Multiparty elections in 1991–1992, after the MPLA had abandoned Marxism, failed to stall the war for long. Power-sharing from 2002 ended when the MPLA won the 2008 election; a presidential poll has yet to be held.



INSIGHT: Angola has the greatest number of amputees (caused by landmines) in the world



THE ECONOMY

Potentially one of Africa's richest countries, but long civil war hampered economic development. Oil and diamonds are exported.



FACTFILE

OFFICIAL NAME: Republic of Angola

DATE OF FORMATION: 1975

CAPITAL: Luanda

POPULATION: 18.5 million

TOTAL AREA: 481,351 sq. miles
(1,246,700 sq. km)

DENSITY: 38 people per sq. mile

LANGUAGES: Portuguese*, Umbundu, Kimbundu, Kikongo

RELIGIONS: Roman Catholic 50%, other 30%, Protestant 20%

ETHNIC MIX: Ovimbundu 37%, other 25%, Kimbundu 25%, Bakongo 13%

GOVERNMENT: Presidential system

CURRENCY: Readjusted kwanza = 100 lwei